

GPT-6 Astra via kie.ai

Step-by-step setup guide (free starter credits, not unlimited free)

Sign-up

kie.ai (Google sign-in supported)

API Key Console

kie.ai/api-key

Endpoint

`https://api.kie.ai/codex/v1/responses`

Model Name

`gpt-6-astra`

Important: This is NOT unlimited free access. New accounts get starter credits, but every request consumes credits from that balance (kie.ai's own docs show 0.48 credits consumed for a small test request). Once credits run out, further use is paid.

Step 1 — Create your account

Go to kie.ai and sign up — Google sign-in is supported for quick access.

Step 2 — Create your API key

Go to kie.ai/api-key and generate a new key. Copy it immediately and keep it private — never expose it in frontend code or public repositories.

Step 3 — Test it in the Playground first

From kie.ai/market, open the GPT-6 Astra model page and use its built-in Playground to send test prompts before writing any code. This is the best way to check output quality without spending API credits on trial and error.

Step 4 — Make your first API call

Every request must include your API key in the Authorization header as a Bearer token.

```
curl --location 'https://api.kie.ai/codex/v1/responses' \
--header 'Authorization: Bearer YOUR_API_KEY' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--data '{
  "model": "gpt-6-astra",
```

```
"input": [
  {
    "role": "user",
    "content": [
      {"type": "input_text", "text": "Hello!"}
    ]
  }
],
"reasoning": {"effort": "high"}
}'
```

Step 5 — Understand credit consumption

Requests are asynchronous and metered by credits, not a flat free quota. Check kie.ai/logs after each call to see exact credit consumption, input/output tokens, and task status — this is the source of truth if you think you were overcharged.

Step 6 — Adjust reasoning effort (optional)

The `reasoning.effort` parameter accepts values from `low` to `xhigh`. Higher effort improves answer quality on hard problems but consumes more credits per request — use lower effort for simple tasks to conserve your balance.

Step 7 — Enable web search (optional)

Add `"tools": [{"type": "web_search"}]` to your request to let GPT-6 Astra search the web mid-response. Note: web search and function calling are mutually exclusive — you can only include one tool type per request.

Step 8 — Monitor your usage and rate limits

kie.ai enforces up to 20 new generation requests per 10 seconds per account, supporting 100+ concurrent tasks for most use cases. If you exceed this, requests return HTTP 429. Keep an eye on your remaining credit balance on the dashboard so you're not caught off guard when free starter credits run out.

Notes: kie.ai is a third-party API gateway offering access to GPT-6 Astra (OpenAI's flagship model) and other frontier models at a markdown versus official provider pricing. It is not an official OpenAI free tier — access is via starter credits that deplete with use, after which standard per-credit pricing applies. Generated media/log data retention and stability details are documented at docs.kie.ai; always confirm current terms before relying on this in production.